

The Final Week

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With less than a week until my Ph.D. viva, I've been taking everyone's advice to heart and not going completely nuts on the revision. After all, I do know this stuff pretty damn well. Anyway, just so I remember what I did this week, I wanted to make a public note of it (probably of more use if, after the event itself, I can say it worked...)

My thesis is broken down into three distinct themes, or sections. For each of those themes, I selected a critical work (usually an introduction to the scheme of thought) that I thought was closest to my stance; refresher material. I also selected a couple of general critical works that I just enjoyed and think resonate closely with my work to get back into the swing of things.

Saturday: Read thesis, read book #1

Sunday: Read book #2, afternoon off

Monday: Read book #3, book #4

Tuesday: Read book #5, annotate thesis

Wednesday: Day off [I'm sitting on an arthritis research UK interview panel]

Thursday: Day off [I have to do my methotrexate injection. Ugh.]

Friday: annotate thesis [planning to re-check the footnotes that I've now forgotten ("for more on X see Y" -- what did "Y" say again?!)]

Saturday: bit more thesis re-reading, afternoon off

Sunday: bit more thesis re-reading, afternoon off

I'm also trying to exercise for at least 40 minutes every day, alternating between a hard workout and a gentler one every other day.